SOUTHERN UNIVERSITY · MBDA LIFT RURAL BUSINESS CENTER

From First Login to a Complete Profile

A visual learning guide to the LIFT client onboarding journey — sign-in, the eight-step wizard, what happens to your answers, and what your profile unlocks.

Prepared November 2, 2026
Audience: LIFT clients, advisors, and program staff
Companion to: LIFT Product Features Brief

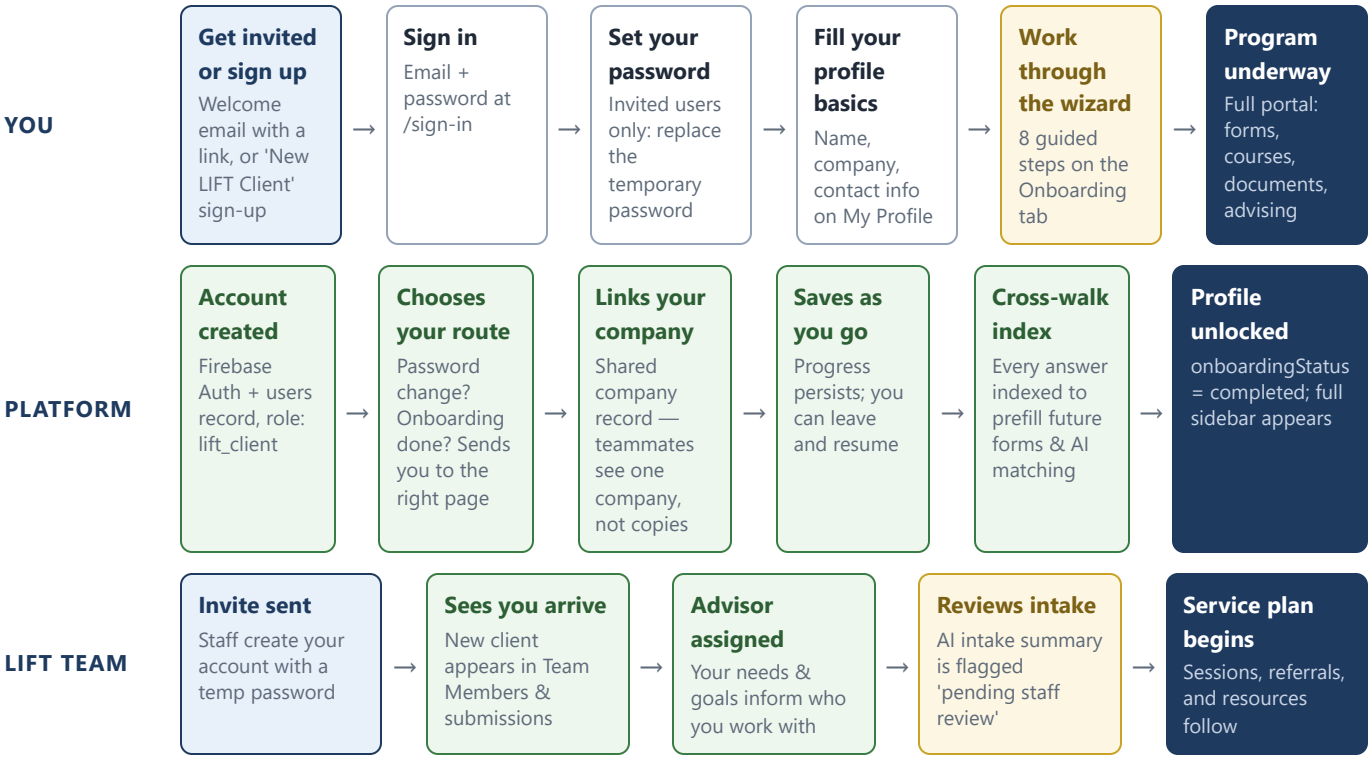
PART 1

The journey at a glance

Every new LIFT client follows the same path. Some steps are yours, some are automatic, and two are decision points where the platform chooses a route for you.

Entry point · You do this · Decision point · Happens automatically · Milestone

The whole trip — three lanes



8	~25	2	1
Wizard steps, each with its own check	Minutes to complete, start to finish	Decision points handled for you	Signature — typed, on the Review step

> **You can stop and come back.** The wizard saves progress against your account. Signing out mid-way and signing back in returns you to the Onboarding tab with your answers intact.

PART 2

Getting in — how sign-in routes you

The sign-in page does more than check your password. After Firebase verifies you, the platform reads your user record and picks one of four destinations.

What the platform checks, in order

Password verified?
Firebase Auth; wrong password shows 'Invalid email or password'

→

Temp password?
hasChangedPassword is false → /change-password first

→

Onboarding done?
lift_client + not complete → Profile with wizard open

→

Portal home
Everyone else lands on /portal

Who signs in	Where they land	Why
Invited user (any role)	/change-password → then normal routing	First login must replace the temporary password from the welcome email.
New LIFT client	/portal/profile?onboarding=start	Profile tab first; the Onboarding tab auto-opens the wizard until finished.
Consortium member	/portal/consortium/onboarding	Separate consortium onboarding flow.
Staff / admin / other roles	/portal	No client onboarding — straight to the workspace.
Returning client (done)	/portal	Wizard skipped; full portal is already unlocked.

Two ways a client account begins

A — Staff invites you

- Welcome email arrives with a **temporary password** and a "Log into the LIFT Platform" link.
- First sign-in forces a password change.
- Then straight into profile + wizard.

B — You sign up yourself

- Sign-up shows a single preselected card: **"New LIFT Client"**.
- Account is created with `lift_client` / `sme_user`.
- Sign in → profile + wizard.

> **Can't open a document or form right after signing in?** Portal files authenticate with a server session, not just your Firebase login. If you see "Forbidden", reload the page once — the platform refreshes the session cookie automatically, then View/Download work.

PART 3

The wizard — steps 1–4

The Onboarding tab walks you through eight cards. Each card validates before you can continue — if something's missing, a message tells you exactly what.

1 Business Information

Tell us about your company

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

Company name | DBA (optional) | Address / city / state / zip | Entity type | Business stage | Employees | Year established | Website

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

Company name (or 'not registered'), full address, entity type, stage, and employee range.

WHY LIFT ASKS

Establishes your business identity — the name, location, and stage that appear on your client record and eligibility reviews. 'Not registered yet' is a valid answer.

2 Capabilities

Describe your products, services, and NAICS codes

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

Products & services list | Primary NAICS code | Core capabilities | Past performance | Key differentiators | Digital tools | Capability statement upload

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

At least one product/service, one NAICS code, and a capabilities description.

WHY LIFT ASKS

This is what the AI matching engine reads. Your NAICS codes and capabilities are what get you matched to contracting opportunities and flagged as a manufacturer for the Proof Pack.

3 Government Contracting

Your GOVCON readiness — SAM.gov, UEI, and certifications

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

GOVCON interest (yes/no) | SAM.gov registration status | UEI & CAGE codes | Certifications held | Certifications planned | Sold to government before?

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

GOVCON interest answer; if yes, your SAM.gov registration status.

WHY LIFT ASKS

Decides how much contracting-readiness support you need. SAM.gov status and certifications drive which readiness steps appear in your service plan.

4 Needs & Goals

What your business needs most and where you're headed

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

- Seeking financing?
- Purpose & amount
- Single most important need
- Barriers holding you back
- 12-month goals
- Kinds of help wanted
- Top-5 business needs pick-list

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

Financing answer, top need, barriers, goals, at least one kind of help, and 1–5 business needs.

WHY LIFT ASKS

The single most important step for your service plan. The top-5 pick-list uses the advisor-curated list of Louisiana business needs (5 Critical, 10 High) — your picks steer advisor assignment, trainings, and resources.

PART 3 (CONTINUED)

The wizard — steps 5–8

5 Operations

How your business wins and delivers work

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

- How you get business today
- Open to teaming?
- Work out of state?
- In-house BD team?
- Resources to invest?

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

Acquisition method and all four yes/no questions.

WHY LIFT ASKS

Four quick yes/no questions tell your advisor how mature your business development is — so recommendations are realistic rather than generic.

6 Contact Information

How can your LIFT advisor reach you?

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

- Primary contact name
- Email & phone
- Preferred contact method
- LinkedIn (or 'no LinkedIn')
- Owner ethnicity
- Additional contacts

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

Name, email, phone, contact method, LinkedIn-or-checkbox, owner ethnicity.

WHY LIFT ASKS

Who your advisor contacts — and each additional contact you add can be invited to the platform with your company already linked.

7 LIFT Program

Service areas, supporting documents, and consents

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

- LIFT service areas
- How you heard about us
- Referring organization
- AI disclosure
- Privacy notice
- Optional document uploads
- Email opt-in

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

At least one service area, referral source + organization, and both acknowledgments.

WHY LIFT ASKS

Chooses which LIFT services you want (counseling, contracting, capital readiness, manufacturing program, digital/AI). Acknowledgments cover the AI assistant and data privacy — no signature needed here.

8 Review

Check everything, certify, and sign

YOU'LL BE ASKED FOR

- Summary of every step
- Accuracy attestation
- Typed legal signature

REQUIRED TO CONTINUE

Attestation checkbox and your typed full legal name.

WHY LIFT ASKS

One screen shows all your answers grouped by step. Certifying + typing your name creates a signed, auditable record — the same legal standing as a handwritten signature on the intake.

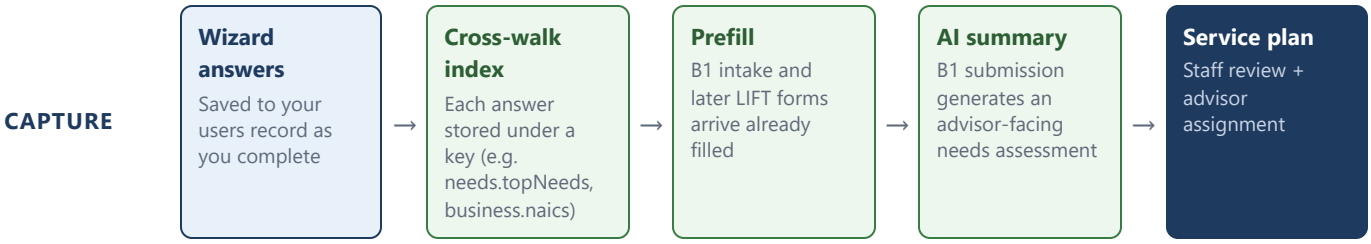
Pressing "Complete onboarding" writes your profile to the platform in one pass, sends invites to any additional contacts you listed, and marks onboarding complete — your full portal unlocks immediately.

PART 4

Where your answers go

Onboarding isn't just paperwork — every field feeds a downstream system so you don't re-enter it later.

Answer lifecycle



Your profile unlocks these

My LIFT forms
B1–B10 lifecycle forms, prefilled from onboarding

Documents
Upload, tag, and share files; role-based visibility

Courses (LMS)
Catalog, enrollment, progress, certificates

Opportunities
Contracting pipeline matched to your profile

Onboarding progress
Checklist of your program milestones

Full sidebar
Navigation gated until the profile is complete

What staff see on their side

Signal	Where it lands
Wizard completion	Team Members list, profile marked complete
Additional contacts	Invite emails sent automatically; contacts join linked to your company
B1 intake submitted	Submissions queue + AI intake summary for advisor review
Top-5 business needs	Stored on your client record; steers advisor match, trainings, resources
Uploaded documents	Stored privately; visible to you and LIFT staff

PART 5

Stuck? Quick fixes

What you see	What to do
"Invalid email or password"	Check for typos; invited users should use the temporary password from the welcome email exactly as sent.
Redirected to change-password every time	Finish the password change once — the platform won't let you proceed until the temp password is replaced.
"Failed to complete onboarding"	Usually a required field on an earlier step. Go back through the steps — the wizard shows which validation failed.
Portal sidebar only shows "My Profile"	Profile required fields aren't complete yet. Finish the profile fields the wizard asks for.
"Forbidden" opening a document	Reload once — the server session refreshes on load and the file will open.
Wizard closed before finishing	Sign back in — you're routed back to Profile → Onboarding with progress saved.
Can't pick a 6th business need	The pick-list is capped at five by design — deselect one first. Choose the ones that matter most.

> **For staff:** the same flow is documented in-app under **Help & Documentation** → **LIFT Client guide**, and the full feature inventory is in the LIFT Product Features Brief (`docs/LIFT_Product_Features_Brief.pdf`).

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